

SITUATIONAL AWARENESS

Situational awareness is observing what is happening all around you and predicting what you should prepare for next. You should do this constantly.

You need to know who might be affected by your actions and who needs to know your intentions. The drivers behind you could be the most affected by your decisions.

HAZARD MANAGEMENT

You will encounter an unlimited number of situations on the road. It would be difficult to predict or have a plan for each one. Instead, you should develop a reliable routine for responding to hazards that requires you to:

- **Plan.** Scan your environment to know what's happening around you. Be sure you also look in your rearview mirror to see what's happening behind you. Decide if the change you want to make is safe.
- **Communicate.** Let others know what you plan to do. Use your signals and make sure everyone is well aware of your intentions.
- **Check.** Prepare your vehicle position and speed so you have adequate space to make your change with no more than medium braking. Recheck your mirrors and look over your shoulder for pedestrians and bicyclists. Make sure no other drivers are trying to move into the same space.
- **Execute.** Make the change smoothly. Try not to surprise anyone. Be ready to change your plan if needed.
- **Evaluate.** Think about how it went. See if you need to adjust your routine for next time.